

YOUR PREGNANCY Time line

From the moment of conception, you and your growing baby go through a multitude of extraordinary changes. Your pregnancy is dated from the first day of your last period. The average length of pregnancy is 40 weeks and it is divided into three parts, or trimesters, which last approximately three months each. Throughout this book, when a “week” is referred to, it means a completed week of pregnancy. This time line of key events gives you an at-a-glance view of your pregnancy journey.

• **Menstruation** Pregnancy is dated from the first day of your last period, so for the first two weeks you are not actually pregnant.

• **Supplements** Take folic acid before you become pregnant, or as soon as you know you are, and continue until 12 weeks pregnant. Take vitamin D throughout your pregnancy, and beyond if you plan to breast-feed.

YOUR DEVELOPING BABY

Although no bigger than a large grape, your baby is developing rapidly. A tiny heart is beating, a little face is taking shape, and limbs are starting to form.



8-WEEK-OLD EMBRYO

THE ANATOMY SCAN

This ultrasound checks your baby's organs, body systems, and limbs. The sonographer may also be able to tell you whether it's a boy or a girl.

First trimester

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12

CONCEPTION

Once a sperm fertilizes an egg, your baby begins life. After several days, it burrows into the lining of the uterus. The place where it implants will develop into the placenta.



Early pregnancy symptoms

You may be experiencing symptoms such as food cravings, morning sickness, extreme fatigue, and mood swings.

• These often fade.

Prenatal appointments

Your first appointment takes place at around 6 to 8 weeks. It will be really thorough and you'll be able to ask the doctor any pregnancy-related questions that you may have.

• **Flu vaccine** Potentially harmful to you and your unborn baby, flu can be prevented through vaccination at any point during pregnancy. Ask your doctor for a flu shot.

• **You're pregnant!** A pregnancy test will detect the presence of a certain hormone that will confirm that you are expecting a baby.

GOOD NEWS!

Second trimester

13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20

Telling others

After the first trimester, or when you've had your first ultrasound, is a good time to tell the wider world about your pregnancy.

Exercise

Keep active and healthy. Your regular exercise may be too strenuous now, so adapt your routine and consider exercise classes especially tailored for pregnant women.

FIRST ULTRASOUND

When you are 8 to 14 weeks pregnant, your baby will be measured from crown to rump and you'll be given an estimated delivery date. Keep in mind, though, that there's a five-week range when birth could happen. You will be offered a nuchal translucency test if you are 11 to 14 weeks.

